Minutes of the Special Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held Electronically on Monday June 29, 2020 at 7:00 p.m.

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		A. Khan
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order

Mayor Collier gave a short introduction regarding the electronic Council meeting format and noted that the meeting was being livestreamed on the Town's website.

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 7:00 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Motion

Mayor Collier vacated the Chair. Deputy Mayor Dies assumed the Chair.

Members took a brief meeting recess in order to address technical difficulties.

Mayor Collier introduced the motion and reviewed its contents. Members of Council asked questions regarding the recruitment and appointment process and discussed the appointment of M. Thomas to the Nominating Committee. Members of Council stated their support for the motion and expressed openness to growth while learning from, and listening to, the Black community on the issue of anti-Black racism.

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: S. Lee

WHEREAS there has been recent movement throughout the United States, Canada, and the World, protesting against the social injustice that has been perpetrated against George Floyd; Rayshard Brooks; Atatiana Jefferson and closer to home, Dafonte Miller and Pamelia and Livingston Jeffers, and all the thousand of Black Lives that have been lost and altered forever.;

AND WHEREAS this is the time for this Council to listen to the voices of members of our Black community and, together with input from members of the Black Lives Matter movement; in order to provide a work plan to address these issues of social injustice that have touched so many lives;

AND WHERAS as an organization committed to supporting our racialized communities, the protests remind us yet again that we have a lot of work to do in addressing racism;

AND WHERAS members of the community are calling on public leaders to take action on systemic and institutional racism to combat barriers felt by Black people, and other racialized groups;

NOW THEREFOR BE IT RESOLVED THAT Ajax Council endorse the creation of an Ajax Anti-Black Racism Congress to run to the end of the term of Council.

AND THAT the Mayor, as the Head of Council, and the Town's Diversity and Inclusion Coordinator act as a liaisons to this Congress

AND THAT Ajax resident, Mariska Thomas, be appointed to the Nominating Committee for the new Anti-Black Racism Congress, and further, be directed to recruit four additional members of the Black community to the committee;

AND THAT the Nominating Committee be directed to:
- develop a Terms of Reference for the Congress;
- develop a recruitment process to attract membership;
- put out a request for interest to the Ajax community only;
- screen applications and appoint Congress members;

AND THAT the Nominating Committee shall cease to exist once the above noted deliverables are completed;

AND THAT Once the Congress has been formed, the membership be authorized to:
- rename the committee, should they choose;
- develop a work plan and meeting schedule;

AND THAT Council endorses the provision of Town resources to the Congress (e.g. strategic advice and guidance, communications support, etc.);

AND THAT Council endorses the provision of an honorariums (similar to that paid to Property Standards and Committee of Adjustment members) for the:
- Nominating Committee;
- Ajax Anti-Black Racism Congress;

AND THAT the Congress be required to update Council with its findings and recommendations prior to implementation and at regular intervals thereafter;

AND THAT any requests for funding and resources to support recommendations be brought forward to Council for authorization, either as part of the annual budget process or separately from that process, as needed.

CARRIED

RECORDED VOTE:

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Khan, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Dies

Opposed: None

Mayor Collier resumed the Chair.

13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That By-law number 23-2020 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its special meeting held on June 29, 2020 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

Regional Councillor Crawford provided a brief update on Regional Council's support to reinstate the Durham Regional Police Service Body-Worn Camera Project.

Members of Council extended wishes to residents of Ajax for a Happy Canada Day.

14. Adjournment

Moved by: A. Khan
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the June 29, 2020 special meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned. (7:20 p.m.)

CARRIED

Mayor

Acting D-Clerk